

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 4, 2026

Mass. slows US tax break, small firms hold the bag

By Larry Edelman
GLOBE COLUMNIST

The email from Trivium Interactive's accountant landed at 1:02 a.m. on a Friday. "Rarely a good omen," said

TRENDLINES

Kirsten Holmes, a principal of the small Boston media company.

"It was 6:30 a.m. when we first read it, and to say we were

devastated would be an understatement," she recalled.

The bad news: Trivium owed more than \$100,000 in state taxes. The unexpected bill resulted from the Legislature's decision, at Governor Maura Healey's urging, to slow the adoption of a federal tax change that allows immediate expensing of research and development costs.

It was the last day of July, the

tax payment was due Sept. 10, and it was "an amount we neither have available nor can pay," Holmes said.

For Trivium, a women-owned firm with more than 40 employees and about \$8 million in annual revenue, "it was a disaster," she said.

Why it matters: Holmes isn't alone.

Thousands of Massachusetts

businesses — it's impossible to say exactly how many — may be facing large tax bills as a result of the state's decision to "decouple" from the R&D deduction provision in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, the GOP's massive tax and spending bill that President Trump signed in July 2025.

Local companies can still claim the full R&D deduction,

TRENDLINES, Page A7

Towns near the Quabbin Reservoir have long lived with the fact that the water goes to Greater Boston. But now, as drought takes its toll, they're fighting for more help — much more — from the east.



ABOVE AND BELOW: MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE; BOTTOM: SWIFT RIVER VALLEY HISTORICAL SOCIETY

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

WENDELL — Robert Bowers was surprisingly upbeat for a man who, just recently, lost his house to a fire. "What can you do?" he said with a smile and a shrug as he surveyed what remained: charred walls, scarred beams, his younger son's high school diploma propped up against a smoke-blackened mantel.

"I just want my house back," said Bowers, who is 84. "I pay my taxes and mind my own business, and, well, things happen."

The question is whether things could — or should — happen differently. The fire started when Bowers's lawn mower overheated in his woodshed. Within minutes, the town's fire chief, Matt O'Donnell, was there with a truck, a hose line, and a problem: He didn't have enough water.

Somehow there's never enough water around here, even though this small hill town is just a few miles away from the plentiful Quabbin Reservoir. But everybody who lives near the reservoir, and its

QUABBIN, Page A5



Matt O'Donnell, fire chief of the towns of New Salem and Wendell, said, "We're the ones who are stewarding this land and we're doing it on our personal dollar." Behind him is the Quabbin Reservoir. At left, the remains of Robert Bowers's home after a fire. Below left, Enfield, once the largest town in the Quabbin Valley, was one of four destroyed by the state in the 1930s to make way for the reservoir.



One juror holding out, Clancy trial goes on

Judge says removal of that person would be improper

By Shelley Murphy and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — With the jury in the murder trial of Lindsay Clancy still unable to come to a consensus after six days of deliberations, the source of that impasse became clear in dramatic fashion in court Thursday: a single holdout.

The startling development came when the jury foreperson sent the trial judge a note about the deliberations that triggered moments of confusion and legal argument over how the trial should continue, and then featured each juror being called individually into court to confer with Judge William F. Sullivan.

While the contents of the note were not disclosed, Clancy's attorney, Kevin Reddington, claimed it showed the holdout was refusing to follow the law regarding reasonable doubt.

Reddington requested Sullivan remove the juror, but he declined, saying it would be improper based on the information provided in the note.

"I don't feel it's appropriate for me to say I agree with one juror or the [other] 11," Sullivan said during a hearing in Plymouth Superior Court out of the presence of jurors.

It was the third straight day the jury signaled it was deadlocked over whether Clancy, who has claimed an insanity defense, should be held criminally responsible for killing her three children in January 2023. Jurors had appealed to Sullivan on Tuesday and Wednesday as well, though without disclosing the details of the impasse, and, on

CLANCY, Page A7

Mass. delegation dreaming of restored clout

Hopes high Democrats can retake House, Senate, or both

By Jim Puzzanghera and Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

When two veteran Massachusetts US representatives finally claimed victory Tuesday night after tough Democratic primary races, it didn't take long for them to dispense with the thank you's and pivot to the even bigger battle to come.

"Let's take it to November, reclaim the House of Representatives, and I can become chair of the Ways and Means Committee again," Representative Richard Neal told cheering supporters in Springfield.

After Neal and South Boston Representative Stephen Lynch prevailed over stronger-than-usual challengers, they're on a glide path to general election wins. Along with Senator Ed Markey, who also beat back an aggressive primary challenger, they convinced enough voters that their age and experience are advantages because of the seniority and power they hold in Washington.

But to unlock the full clout of the all-Democrat Massachusetts delegation, the party has to win the majority in the House or Senate — and ideally both.

If it does, the state's long-serving incumbents are in line to be in top leadership positions and

DEMOCRATS, Page A6

GLORIA STEINEM 1934-2026

At Smith and beyond, her words resound

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

NORTHAMPTON — Gloria Steinem, who died at the age of 92 Wednesday, will be remembered as a pioneering feminist. But I will always think of her first as a pioneering journalist with a fierce interest in *everything*.

APPRECIATION

I first met Steinem while she was visiting her alma mater, Smith College (class of '56), more than a decade ago, and we had just a brief passing exchange. She was around 80 then.

The next time I "encountered" her at Smith was a back-in-time moment, when she was a 31-year-old writer with long dark hair who was making a big name for herself in New York City. I was researching my book, "Enter Helen: The Invention of Helen Gurley Brown and the Rise of the Modern Single Woman," about the late editor of Cosmopolitan magazine and I had found the collected papers of both women in the Sophia Smith Collection of Women's History.

In the 1960s, Steinem was literally a model in every sense: She even appeared in photographs accompanying the articles she wrote for magazines. In the October 1965 issue of Glamour

STEINEM, Page C9



SCOTT APPLEWHITE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE 1981

Gloria Steinem attended a rally for the Equal Rights Amendment on July 4, 1981. **Obituary, C9.**



Cooking show

Friday: Drier, hot.

High 81-86. Low 62-67.

Saturday: Maybe a shower.

High 70-75. Low 58-63.

High tide: 5:02 a.m., 5:20 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:12 Sunset: 7:13

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 310, NO. 66

*

Suggested retail price

\$4.00



A federal judge in Boston chastised lawyers for the Justice Department who presented arguments for a Trump administration policy that restricts the duration of international student visas. **B1.**

State Senator William Brownsberger and challenger Daniel Lander both requested a recount, with their race separated by just four votes. **B1.**

The Trump administration released new rules that could revoke tax-exempt status from any school offering targeted support to Black or other minority students. **A2.**

A major Dunkin' franchise operator in the area and two staffing firms will pay \$1.46 million in fines for improperly classifying workers and not paying them on time. **B5.**